The Seventy Week Prophecy

Purpose: *To reveal the absolutely compelling evidence that Jesus Christ is the Messiah! To draw attention to an ancient prophecy that's gives the key to unlock the most significant event this world has ever witnessed.*

Centred on: *Daniel 9.*

Daniel 8: 13-14… Remember the day for a year principle in bible prophecy (Ezekiel 4: 6; Numbers 14: 34).

This verse is speaking of the sanctuary. If we know nothing else, we at least know that it has something to do with the life and ministry of Jesus.

Daniel 8: 16-17… **Note:** Gabriel is the agent who has come to help Daniel understand the vision. This vision also has to do with the time of the end. In Summary:

- Has something to do with the life and ministry of Jesus.
- Has something to do with the time of the end.

Daniel 8: 26-27… Notice Daniel did not understand the vision.

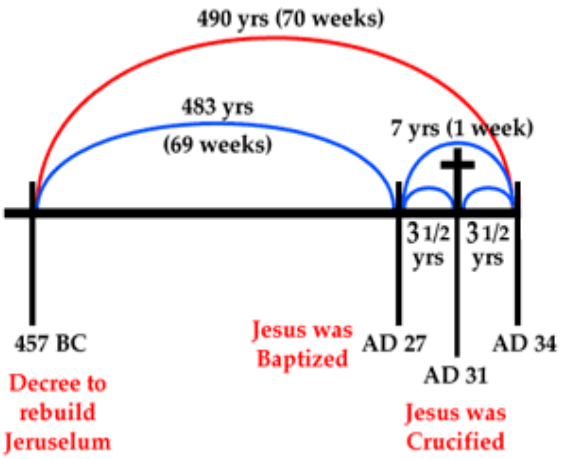
Daniel 9: 20-23… Recap: Gabriel visits Daniel in Chapter 8 to give him understanding about the vision concerning the "two thousand three hundred days." At this point, Daniel doesn't get it. Now here in Daniel 9, Daniel begins to pray. Before he finishes his prayer someone pays him a visit? Gabriel again presents himself to give understanding of the vision initiated in chapter 8.

Daniel 9: 24… Seventy weeks ***"are determined."*** Hebrew: *chathak.* (Amputate). In view of the fact that chapter 9 is an exposition of the unexplained portion of the vision of chapter 8 and inasmuch as the unexplained portion had to do with the 2300 days, it is logical to conclude that the 70 weeks, or 490 years, were to be "cut off" (amputated), from that longer period.

Internal evidence for the day for a year principle.

<u>6 events prescribed to happen over the 490 years.</u>

- To finish the transgression.
- To make an end of sins.
- To make reconciliation for iniquity.
- To bring in everlasting righteousness.
- To seal up the vision and prophecy.
- To Anoint the Most Holy.



Daniel 9: 25… Here we are given a starting point to the seventy weeks. Whenever the Jews are given permission to return to Jerusalem to rebuild their city, that's when this prophecy begins. At the time this vision was given, Jerusalem and the Temple were still in ruins. Heaven announces that a command will be issued to rebuild and restore. From that date, a definite number of years will reach to the long awaited Messiah. So when was this date? (Mat 18:22) The Hebrew word Messiah is the same as Christ "The anointed one"

Ezra 7: 11-26… This decree was made by King Artaxerxes in the seventh year of his reign when he allowed the Jews to return to Jerusalem and rebuild their city.

Note: This starting date of 457 B.C. is verified in history through the writings of Greek historian Herodotus, through Babylonian records and through the Alexandrian astronomer Ptolemy (anon of Ptolemy). Sir Isaac Newton, one of the greatest scientists ever, documented this starting date as "among the most easily established dates in history" (Observations upon the prophecies of the bible, pp154-157).

Interesting fact: Clearly this prophecy has major ramifications for the Jews. Do the Jews know about this prophecy? What do they think about it? Should their search for the Messiah be over? In a bizarre twist, not only is this prophecy known to Jewish scholars, but a rabbinical curse has been placed on any Jew who reads this code to discover the timing of the coming Messiah.

One Jewish Sage said:

"May the spirits of those who attempt to calculate the final time of Mashiach's coming, expire" (Sanhedrin 97B, Quoted in Chapter 12 of Hillchos Melachim from the Mishneh Tora of Rambam). (Note: "Mashiach" is Hebrew for "Messiah").

Daniel 9: 25… Daniel was told the Messiah would come 69 weeks after the command to rebuild Jerusalem. If that command was made in 457 B.C, then 69 weeks (483 literal years) brings us to the date of 27 A.D. (remember there is no zero year). So, according to this time prophecy, the Messiah would arrive in 27 A. D.

This is one of the most exciting aspects of this prophecy. "Messiah" means "the anointed one". Up until 27 A.D. Jesus was a tradesman, working each day as a carpenter. In 27 A.D. His life completely changed. Jesus was baptised in the Jordan River and anointed by the Holy Spirit (Acts 10: 37-38). He left his job as a tradesman and began His public ministry as the Messiah for the Jews.

Acts 10: 37-38…Jesus is depicted as being anointed by the Holy Spirit at his baptism.

Matthew 3: 16-17…Here there seems to be quite an emphasis placed on the baptism of Jesus.

John 1: 32,41…John is also placing an emphasis on Jesus. V41 The people are now saying "we have found the Messiah". Jesus is the Messiah.

So what was the purpose of the anointing?

Luke 4: 18…To preach the Gospel.

Mark 1: 14-15…Jesus first sermon: "The time is fulfilled."

Jesus knew the prophetic codes of Daniel well. He even said "*whoever reads, let him understand*" (Matthew 24: 15). Jesus understood his role in life and He knew that his baptism was the start of his public life and ministry as the Messiah. (Luk 3:1 – Secular history say Tiberius Caesar AD27)

But this is only part of the prophecy. There still remains 1 week of the total 70 weeks.

Daniel 9: 26-27…In an amazing twist, we find the Messiah being cut off (or killed). Instead of a king to deliver the Jews from slavery, we find a king who suffers and dies. The prophecy tells us that this Messiah king did not die for himself. Jesus did not deserve to die-He never sinned. Jesus died for us. His perfect life was offered to save you from your sins and give you a hope for the future.

Daniel 9: 27… Then He shall confirm a covenant with many, **for one week?** (more on this later).

Matthew 26: 28…Jesus is declaring the direct fulfilment of Daniel 9: 27.

Daniel 9: 27…**The "middle" of the last week** (being half of the last seven years) is three and a half years after the coming of the Messiah in AD 27. That would bring us to AD 31-right on time according to Bible prophecy.

Matthew 27: 51… When Jesus died, the curtain in the temple was miraculously ripped from top to bottom. This symbolised the end to animal sacrifices exactly as the Bible predicted.

In the temple service the Passover lamb was sacrificed once a year on a specific day and at a specific time (the afternoon of the 14th day of the Hebrew month Nissan). As the Priests were preparing to kill the Passover lamb, Jesus was dying on a lonely cross. On that dark afternoon, prophecy was fulfilled as "*Christ, our Passover, was sacrificed for us*" (1 Corinthians 5: 7).

Matthew 10: 5-6…Jesus is giving clear instruction to preach to the Jewish nation ONLY!

After being anointed as the Messiah in 27 AD, Jesus knew the Jewish nation had only seven years left to repent and accept him as their Messiah and saviour from sin. Jesus instructed his disciples to focus on preaching to Israel. He longed for the Jewish nation to accept him and present him as the Messiah to the whole world. Even after his death, Jesus told his disciples to begin their ministry at Jerusalem. He had not given up on the people of Jerusalem. There was still time for them to accept Jesus as their saviour.

Matthew 21: 43, 45…Jesus knew the prophecy of Daniel 9 and had passionately warned them about rejecting him as their Messiah. He declares the great promises of a glorious future would be taken away from the Jews and given to another people.

Acts 13: 46-47…The disciples understood their commission and carried out their ministry toward the Jewish nation but knew there time would come to an end.

Romans 2: 10…Again we see the order of things pertaining to the gospel.

John 1: 11…John is describing how the Jewish nation rejected the Messiah.

Genesis 22: 18…The preaching to the Jews was with a view to their becoming the means by which "all the nations of the earth" should "be blessed" by knowledge of salvation through Jesus Christ. They rejected this privilege. But despite this, the message was taken to the Gentiles.

So when did the gospel begin to go to the gentile nation?

Acts 7:59; 8: 1-4…When Stephen was killed by the Jewish religious leaders; he became the first Christian martyr. This occurred in 34 AD, exactly 490 years after the start of the prophecy. This year marked the completion of the Jewish probation time. When God saw what the Jewish leaders did to the leadership of his emerging church, he must have said in his heart "enough is enough, go now and preach the gospel to the gentiles." Because the Jewish nation hardened themselves against the longsuffering love of their God, the prophecy was over. *see appendix.

Christianity demands you to use your brain
God doesn't expect you to believe without giving sufficient evidence for your faith

This prophecy proves to us that God will never break his promises

Paul is converted in the same year as **Stephen's stoning**(acts 7,9) Gal 1:18 (after 3yrs first visit to Jerusalem) Gal 2:1(after 14 yrs 2nd visit = 17yrs)Acts 18:12(Gallio)
A stone was discovered in Corinth giving tribute to Gallio who served for 1yr, dated AD51- "the Delphi inscription" this brings us back to AD34. Stephen revealed God's offer of mercy throughout the ages for Israel to come back to God before close of probation AD34. Mat 18:22(490 years)

Additional points:

John 2: 4… **John 7: 6…** **John 7: 30…** **John 12: 23, 27…** **John 17: 1…**	**Jesus was operating on a time line!**

<u>Key points to understand regarding the 70 weeks time prophecy:</u>

- The prophecy provides a master key to unlock the other passages in the Bible.
- This prophecy reassures our confidence in the inspiration of scripture.
- Confirms our faith that Jesus Christ is in fact the Messiah.
- Prophecy demonstrates the love of God (even after His church apostatized, he gave them considerable probation time to repent and return to him. God will never break his covenant with his people).

Appendix: The Seventy Week Prophecy

The Stoning of Stephen;



Three fairly obvious objectives can be inferred for Stephen's speech:

1. To win approval, or rather to temper disapproval, by showing the Sanhedrin that he had familiarity with Hebrew history, and to provide ground for proving his orthodoxy.

2. To show historically how God had sought to lead the Hebrews, and how persistently they had rejected that leadership as given through Moses, the prophets, and the long-foretold Messiah.

3. To show the nature and meaning of the worship that God had prescribed for the patriarchs and for His chosen people, in relation, as must be recognized, to Christ's newly inaugurated work at the right hand of God. This may be considered the most important, but least clearly stated, objective. Four facts are to be observed in connection with it:

a. When the deacons, of whom Stephen emerges as the leading evangelist, began their public ministry, "a great company of the priests," it is noted for the first time, "were obedient to the faith" (ch. 6:7). This result may have arisen from a particular emphasis in the presentation of the gospel by Stephen and the other deacons.

b. The serious accusation was brought against Stephen that he taught what was contrary to "this holy place," that is, the Temple; to "the law"; and to the "customs" (ch. 6:13, 14).

c. Stephen stressed the call of Abraham and God's providential care of Jacob and his descendants (ch. 7:2–17); the liberation of the Hebrews from Egypt under the leadership of Moses (vs. 18–36); Moses' witness to a future prophet for the church in the wilderness (vs. 37, 38); the false worship and unconsecrated sacrifices of the Hebrews (vs. 39–43); the wilderness tabernacle built according to the pattern shown to Moses (vs. 44, 45); Solomon's Temple (vs. 46, 47); and the fact that God is in no need of man-made temples (vs. 48–50). This emphasis upon worship would suggest that Stephen was leading to the subject of Christ's ministry in heaven.

d. Stephen's experience bears a recognizable relationship to the prophecy of the 70 weeks (Dan. 9:24–27), which began in 457 b.c., in the last week of which Messiah was to be cut off, "not for himself," and the typical, earthly sacrificial system was to end as an effective means of intercession, which result would mean also the end of the earthly priesthood. This commentary accepts the view that the crucifixion took place in a.d. 31, "in the midst of the week." Therefore the last of the 70 prophetic weeks must end in a.d. 34. Thus Stephen's ministry can be viewed as dramatically symbolizing God's appeal to His chosen people during the last prophetic week, before the gospel is offered to the Gentiles. Accordingly, it seems reasonable to date Stephen's martyrdom in a.d. 34, for the killing of Stephen may be viewed as a final act of rejection of the gospel by the Jews as a nation.

When Stephen's speech is viewed against this background, it is seen to be a dramatic, vital episode in a critical period of early church history.

Vision of the 2300 days:

A contextual and linguistic approach:



Can we be sure the seventy weeks prophecy of Daniel 9: 24-27 is in any way linked to the 2300 days of Daniel 8: 14? The answer is unequivocally yes! In fact, using the Reformation backbone method of exegesis-"sola scriptura", we will further discover that the seventy weeks are not only linked to, but are in fact a smaller piece of a bigger picture….

To begin, Daniel 2, Daniel 7, and Daniel 8 are chapters that consist of dreams/visions followed by an interpretation of the dream/vision, though in Daniel 8 the interpretation was incomplete. In contrast, Daniel 9, unlike these other previous chapters, has no dreams or visions; it consists only of an interpretation-the seventy week prophecy given to him by Gabriel.

Here's how Daniel depicts the arrival of Gabriel:

"Yea, whiles I was speaking in prayer, even the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening oblation. And he informed me, and talked with me, and said, O Daniel, I am now come forth to give thee skill and understanding. At the beginning of thy supplications the commandment came forth, and I am come to shew thee; for thou art greatly beloved: therefore understand the matter, and consider the vision" (Daniel 9: 21-23. KJV).

Notice the3 underlined sections above all express Gabriel's intent to explain something to Daniel, to give him understanding, to show him something. As we will see, he came to interpret for Daniel the *one part of the vision* in chapter 8-the 2300 days-that was not already interpreted to him.

The vision in Daniel 8 consists of the ram, the goat, the little horn, and the sanctuary being cleansed (the 2300 days). The ram was interpreted, the goat was interpreted, and the little horn was interpreted (Daniel 8: 19-25); the only part of the vision that wasn't interpreted was the part dealing with the 2300 days, the part Daniel said he didn't understand…

Listen carefully to what Daniel says here:

"And the vision of the evening and the morning which was told is true: wherefore shut thou up the vision; for it shall be for many days. 27 And I Daniel fainted, and was sick certain days; afterward I rose up, and did the king's business; and I was astonished at the vision, but none understood it" (Daniel 8: 26, 27. KJV).

Firstly, when Gabriel talks about the vision of the "evening and morning" in the above text, he is talking about Daniel 8: 14, which reads (more literally), "until evening morning 2300…." Gabriel's reference, then, in verse 26, to the vision of the "evening and morning" points specifically to the 2300 days of Daniel 8: 14. Daniel said that he didn't understand it, that is, he didn't understand the vision about the 2300 days, which isn't surprising because everything else in chapter 8 had been explained.

Also, two different Hebrew words are translated "vision" in Daniel 8. In verses 1 and 2, Daniel three times makes reference to the "vision" of the chapter, and each time it comes to the same Hebrew word, *hazon:*

"In the third year of the reign of king Belshazzar a vision (hazon) appeared unto me, even unto me Daniel, after that which appeared unto me at the first. 2 And I saw in a vision (hazon); and it came to pass, when I saw, that I was at Shushan in the palace, which is in the province of Elam; and I saw in a vision (hazon), and I was by the river of Ulai" (Daniel 8: 1, 2).

Daniel then describes what he sees in the *hazon*: the ram, the goat, the little horn etc. *Hazon* therefore refers to the general vision of chapter 8. In contrast, when he talks specifically about the 2300 days, Daniel uses a different word for vision, *mareh*…

"And the vision [mareh] of the evening and the morning which was told is true: wherefore shut thou up the vision (hazon); for it shall be for many days. And I Daniel fainted, and was sick certain days; afterward I rose up, and did the king's business; and I was astonished at the vision [mareh], but none understood it" (Daniel 8: 26, 27).

Thus we have two words for "vision" in Daniel 8: *hazon* for the whole vision, and *mareh* for Daniel 8: 14, the vision regarding the 2300 days and the sanctuary being cleansed-the only part that Daniel didn't understand (Daniel 8: 27).

Now these two words appear again, in Daniel 9, when Gabriel appears to Daniel after his prayer…

"Yea, whiles I was speaking in prayer, even the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision (hazon) at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening oblation. And he informed me, and talked with me, and said, O Daniel, I am now come forth to give thee skill and understanding. At the beginning of thy supplications the commandment came forth, and I am come to shew thee; for thou art greatly beloved: therefore understand the matter, and consider the vision [mareh]" (Daniel 9: 21-23).

Notice, Daniel refers to Gabriel, the angel he had seen in the *hazon* of Daniel 8. Notice, too, that Gabriel comes to Daniel and says that he's here to give him "skill and understanding." Skill and understanding about what? The last time we left Daniel, he didn't understand the *mareh* of Daniel 8: 14. Thus it seems that Gabriel appears in chapter 9 to give Daniel the understanding that he didn't have in chapter 8. This point becomes even clearer when we examine the word for "vision" that Gabriel uses in verse 23 just before giving Daniel the seventy week prophecy…

Look at this carefully:
"At the beginning of thy supplications the commandment came forth, and I am come to shew thee; for thou art greatly beloved: therefore understand the matter, and consider the vision" [mareh] (Daniel 9: 23).

Mareh? What *mareh*? There's only one, the *mareh* of the 2300 evenings and mornings in 8: 14 that Daniel didn't understand. Another point: What kind of prophecy was the *mareh* of Daniel 8: 14? It was a time prophecy, and what is the first thing that Gabriel gives to Daniel? Of course, a time prophecy-the seventy weeks-that he begins to explain in Daniel 9:24. Without question, Gabriel comes to Daniel in chapter 9 in order to give him the explanation about the 2300 days in chapter 8. How interesting, too, that the *mareh* of Daniel 8: 14, unlike the rest of the *hazon,* constitutes an audition, something that Daniel hears, as opposed to something he sees, as in the rest of the vision. In Daniel 8, the *mareh* of the 2300 days is revealed in words, not in visible symbols. In Daniel 9, when Gabriel returns and gives him the explanation, he doesn't give Daniel a vision of rams, goats, little horns, etc; he gives him something to hear, an audition, as with the *mareh* of chapter 8.

"Cut off":

*"Seventy weeks are determined (**Chatchak**), upon thy people and upon thy Holy city…."* (Daniel 9: 24). Most Hebrew lexicons give one of the meanings of *Chatchak*, often the primary meaning, as "cut off, to divide", with the idea of issuing a decree. Now if we remain consistent with the context of the text, we are given two time prophecies, the bigger one comes first, followed by the smaller one, which is introduced (in the context of the bigger) by the verb *"Chatchak",* which has a basic meaning of "to cut off".
Is it then an outrageous conclusion to assume that the smaller number, the seventy weeks, is cut off from the larger one, the 2300 days? Hardly, it is in fact, the only logical conclusion.